

technologies based on what skill was most common among the dev team that would require minimal learning effort.

There is no single rule in adoption of a technology to fit your needs but questions like:

- What are the functional and non-functional requirements that this technology needs to satisfy?
- What are the selection criteria?

These questions can go a long way in filtering out a few from among a number of available options.

Another trend that is a bit dangerous is how sometimes we blindly follow or try to incorporate whatever technology is “hot” in the industry. While using an industry buzzword might seem like a no-brainer, sometimes based on the situation at hand, the “industry-ranked-best” tool might not be the best fit for your application. An analogy for this would be how swiss knives are known for their all-powerful and capable utility but if you can carry only a small bag (or only a light tool), then a swiss knife, however well rated and recommended, might not be the solution.

At the time of writing of this article, a couple of technology buzzwords that have been dominating the industry are noSQL, Cloud Computing, Machine Learning etc. While each of these technologies are a powerful and formidable tool, it would depend entirely on the use-case whether we are able to benefit from them or not. Long story short, stick to the questionnaire above for your choices, don't get carried away when you hear how Amazon has an incredible face-recognition technology and try to apply it to your accounting software. Unless there is a use-case for it.

NOTE:

A lot of hype has evolved around tools (UML-based or otherwise) that help in this phase of the design. While there are tools offering a variety of features like Modelio or LucidChart, it is the opinion of this author that in most cases (if not all) whiteboarding, sketches and post-its



are the best methods to start the design phase. It can then be moved on to one of the tools for a more expanded and detailed definition.